MONTHLY UPDATE

Connectivity: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *47 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

ALGERIA · ANGOLA · BOTSWANA · BURKINA FASO · BURUNDI · CAMEROON · CAPE VERDE · CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC · CHAD · CONGO · COTE D'IVOIRE · DJIBOUTI · DR CONGO · EGYPT · EQUATORIAL GUINEA · ETHIOPIA · GABON · GAMBIA · GHANA · GUINEA · GUINEA-BISSAU · KENYA · LESOTHO · LIBYA · MADAGASCAR · MALAWI · MALI · MAURITANIA · MAURITIUS · MOZAMBIQUE · NAMIBIA · NIGER · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SAO TOME AND PRINCIPE · SENEGAL · SIERRA LEONE · SOMALIA · SOUTH AFRICA · SOUTH SUDAN · SUDAN · TANZANIA · TOGO · TUNISIA · UGANDA · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

On 7 September state media stated that within 18 months no zone would remain out of network, in an operation covering at least 3,000 enclaved and hard-to-reach rural zones; no instrument, budget, operator or zone list accompanies the statement. Oran joined Algiers among the world's top 50 cities for mobile internet speed on a measurement firm's September update.

Angola

The national fibre network opened its first link at Lobito on 16 September, a DWDM route from Luanda through Bengo and Cuanza Sul, with Huambo, Namibe and Cabinda named next; the same day a fibre-to-the-home service went live for a 1,000-dwelling housing centre at Baia Farta. The ministry put the section completed to Lobito at about 400 Gb. Separately the national radio finished the Luanda phase of a transmitter programme meant to raise coverage from 63 to 76 per cent of the population.

The incumbent operator reported more than 21.2 million subscribers and 12,302 base stations for the first half of 2026, with 5G extended to Namibe, Malanje, Kwanza Sul, Zaire and Cabinda, on its own figures.

The national cable company began deploying new optical equipment across its South Atlantic and MONET submarine systems, adding 800G interfaces on a 12,780 km Angola-United States route at 130 ms round trip, on the equipment vendor's announcement of 29 September. No capacity total or completion date is stated.

Botswana

On 23 September the state wholesaler said it had signed a long-term lease with an unnamed South African partner, raising available international capacity through the Ramatlabama and Pioneer Gate crossings from 300 Gbit/s to 1 Tbit/s. The term and price were not disclosed. The state fibre operator announced the launch of its internet exchange point for local traffic; no member count is given.

The communications minister said the Universal Access and Service Fund's broadband expansion project has deployed 12 mobile broadband and voice sites along the Trans-Kalahari Highway, a P34.5 million investment, with further coverage through infrastructure sharing due by the end of the next financial year.

Burkina Faso

The minister put 3,140 public buildings on the national administration network on 8 October 2026, against 2,332 in the state ICT agency's 2020 report. The minister said on 8 October 2026 that 750 villages with no network will be connected by end-2026 and 750 more by 2028, on FCFA 25bn mobilised by the State, under a target of no white zones by 2030.

Burundi

International capacity moved for the first time in the record: Tanzania's state operator and the Burundi Backbone System agreed to raise the Tanzanian route from 4Gbps to 10Gbps on 9 September. Nothing is published for the Rwandan or Congolese routes, so the country's total is still unknown.

Cameroon

The state operator took delivery of a second shipment of equipment from China for 245 new mobile sites, which would take its declared network from 473 to 718, weighted to rural and district areas. No cost or completion date is stated.

The lender reviewed the E-National Higher Education Network with the higher-education ministry on 24 September. The ministry listed 500,000 student computers, ten university digital-development centres and campus interconnection among its outputs, with no usage figure or new financing. The state operator and the secondary education ministry signed a framework agreement to interconnect 130 schools in the three northern regions.

Cape Verde

The national operator and a European exchange operator signed a non-binding letter of intent, announced on 29 September, for a South Atlantic interconnection corridor: transport capacity between Lisbon and Sao Paulo in exchange for access to exchanges in Frankfurt, Madrid, Marseille, New York and Sao Paulo. Scope and commercial terms await a definitive agreement.

Central African Republic

The country's dependence on one neighbour was examined. A published assessment set out the options for reaching submarine cable capacity other than through Cameroon. For a landlocked country, the transit route is the bandwidth constraint. The assessment names alternatives; the record held carries no route secured, no agreement signed and no capacity figure.

The digital-economy minister and his Congolese counterpart agreed in Moscow on 8 October 2026 on the need to carry out a fibre interconnection with the Democratic Republic of Congo, which the ministry says would reach the submarine cable landing at Moanda; no timetable or financing was announced.

Chad

The ministry measured the backbone's shortfall. Meeting the World Bank's resident representative on 15 September, the minister put the remaining need at about 8,000 km of fibre for a full national mesh, with six provinces still unconnected. The minister told German, European and cooperation-agency representatives on 9 October 2026 that the country has about 6,000 km of optical fibre and aims for 14,000 km.

Congo

The universal access and service fund put a cumulative figure on the record for the first time: more than 380,000 people in formerly isolated areas now have communication infrastructure, and more than 250 localities are better linked to urban centres and essential services. The figure was given at a regional workshop on emergency telecommunications, where the country's own plan is still to be written; it covers the fund's whole life rather than the period, and the fund has published no annual series against which to read it.

Cote d'Ivoire

The largest operator said construction works severed several of its cables in an Abidjan district on 2 September, cutting service to more than 1,121 customers. It named the construction company and threatened legal action.

Djibouti

On 7 September the Djiboutian, Ethiopian and Sudanese operators presented the Horizon terrestrial fibre corridor to Google, Meta, Microsoft, Amazon, other carriers and equipment makers at a pre-commercialisation meeting in Addis Ababa, seeking partners, customers and technical feedback before deployment. The account gives no cost, financing or ready-for-service date, and no attendee commitment.

DR Congo

A cross-border route was reaffirmed rather than started. The Tanzanian and Congolese foreign ministries agreed to fast-track a fibre-optic cable from Kigoma to Kalemie in Tanganyika province through Lake Tanganyika, alongside a standard gauge railway link through Burundi and the establishment of a joint economic commission. The statement came at a farewell meeting for the Congolese ambassador in Dar es Salaam; no route survey, cost, financing, landing point or delivery date is published, and no Congolese ministry statement is on file.

The posts and telecommunications minister presented the commercial launch of 5G to the Council of Ministers on 9 October 2026, starting in urban areas, with no operator, spectrum assignment, licence fee or date stated; he had said in late September that government was working toward availability before the end of 2026. The digital-economy minister and his Central African counterpart agreed in Moscow on 8 October on the need to carry out a fibre interconnection between the two countries, with no timetable or financing.

Egypt

On 7 September the incumbent's agreement with Power Sub Link to construct the 200 km Sharm El Sheikh to Taba cable was reported, extending its Red Sea festoon into a continuous Suez – Zafarana – Ras Ghareb – Sharm El Sheikh – Taba route designed for about 5 petabits per second. Earlier accounts put the contractor as Greek; no cost, landing-station arrangement or in-service date is held either way.

Vodafone Egypt began the commercial rollout of an AI-capable radio-access processor built for 5G-Advanced (21 September), with no site count or value given.

The main exchange, EG-IX, peaked at 722.19Gb/s on 7 September across 18 member networks, only five of them Egyptian; it is owned by the state-controlled incumbent.

Equatorial Guinea

The terms followed on 9 September, when the government launched the service officially and reserved its sale to the state, with a dedicated revenue account and privately signed contracts cancelled. No licence text, tariff or subscriber figure is published.

Access then narrowed for everyone else. Since 2 September bandwidth has been throttled and Facebook and TikTok unreachable without a VPN, after a viral video accusing the vice-president of corruption whose author was arrested; no order has been published and the information ministry did not answer questions. The Vice-President instructed the finance ministry on 7 October 2026 to investigate and expedite the financing file for the operator's network agreement with the vendor, slowed by Treasury payment arrears to the operator.

Ethiopia

The second licensee now puts itself at 15 million ninety-day active customers and more than 3,600 sites in five years of operation, and told the innovation and technology minister that timely customs clearance of telecommunications equipment and fibre cable constrains further rollout. The incumbent's Year II business plan sets 2026/27 targets of 96.2 million customers, 4G sites from 6,924 to 11,014, 5G towns from 33 to 73 and international gateway capacity from 4.3 Tbps to 5.2 Tbps; they are targets published by the operator, and no outturn against them is held.

Gabon

The backbone is moving to a partnership. The state infrastructure holding company and a private operator validated a PPP over 3,420km of national backbone, 1,769km already built and 1,651km planned, with signature set for 14 September, and signed it that day as a twenty-year partnership in which the network stays state property. No financing has closed. The incumbent operator and the ministry signed a convention ceding to the State the 196 km Fougamou-Mouila fibre section.

Gambia

The country renumbered its mobile network. The transition to nine-digit numbers began on 4 September 2026, existing numbers taking a two-digit operator prefix — 87 for Africell, 83 for QCell and 86 for Comium; Gamcel numbers are not affected in this phase and keep their seven digits. The numbering plan instrument is not published, and nothing states when the deferred operator joins.

The number change has a legal base and an end date. The regulator's National Numbering Plan 2026 took effect on 3 September with a migration framework of eight readiness gates and rollback states, and seven-digit numbers retire permanently on 28 February 2027.

Ghana

Spectrum assignment got a date on 7 September: the minister said that spectrum assignment would be completed and 5G deployment begin by December 2026, alongside a road-excavation coordination framework, an Emergency Telecommunications Framework and upgraded network-quality standards operators would be required to meet. It is a ministerial statement, not a published award timetable.

The build was then put in proportion. On 6 September the minister put the national requirement at about 6,000 additional cell sites against roughly 1,100 in the current round, which is to complete in 2027 — stated without the coverage or quality standard it is measured against. What is actually being built is 800 sites committed by the dominant operator with 180 already active and carrying traffic, and a 2026 plan of 2,698 sites at the second operator of which 1,890 are live within a network of roughly 9,000, and the regulator spent the week taking radio-frequency exposure messaging to market traders and transport operators in Koforidua after opposition to a mast at a lorry station — the cost of the build showing up as consent rather than capital.

The backbone under it is losing ground faster than the record showed. Industry now projects 8,578 fibre cuts nationwide in 2026, 4,289 of them already in the first half, at roughly US$2,045 a repair against more than US$20m spent on repairs in 2025, with major corridors averaging 72 cuts a month and uncoordinated excavation under the government's own road programme accounting for about half of road-related cuts. The dig-once policy that answers it has slipped again: a joint Cabinet memorandum with the roads ministry now awaits Cabinet, its third-quarter 2026 implementation target passed with no instrument on record. Against that, voice over LTE has risen from about 7% of traffic to 22.43% on 8.4 million subscribers.

The state's own operator got its board back. On 3 September a seven-member board was sworn in for the company behind the AT Ghana brand, releasing policy directives that had gone unimplemented for almost two months for want of one: spectrum in three bands from the regulator, and core-network access from the universal-access fund, both held back pending audited accounts. Neither the bands nor the terms of the access are published.

The first 5G spectrum is assigned. The regulator awarded both 700 MHz lots on 11 September to the dominant operator, the sole qualified applicant, for US$100.9m, US$100,000 above the floor its 40% premium set; one press account prints US$109.9m, against the regulator's own release. At the 2.3 GHz stage the second operator took all three lots it applied for, of five on offer, with neither the assignment date nor the fee stated.

On 25 September in New York the President discussed with Amazon's chief global affairs officer using the company's low-orbit satellite network to connect underserved communities. No partnership, licence application or service date has been announced. The dominant operator announced on 2 October that the regulator had notified it of 15-year awards of two lots in the 700 MHz band for US$100.9m and all three lots in the 3 GHz band for US$101.1m, to be deployed for 5G once the licences issue. The second operator's parent group signed a three-year, US$200m network modernisation memorandum with its Chinese equipment supplier.

Guinea

The national internet exchange point was represented at the fifteenth African peering and interconnection forum in Kigali from 17 to 20 August 2026, with the digital ministry's support through a regional digital integration programme.

Guinea-Bissau

The satellite operator's licence stayed provisional. The regulator extended Starlink's provisional general authorisation to 31 December 2026 by Despacho 15/CA/ARN/2026 of 14 September, to keep the service running while the definitive general-authorisation regime is put in place. The service has been live since June 2025, and no subscriber count or tariff has been published.

Kenya

The government fibre programme was measured against its own deadline for the first time. The ICT Cabinet Secretary put 37,000km installed against the 100,000km target serving 53,000 government facilities, leaving 63,000km outstanding months before the 2027 deadline; the programme was announced in November 2022 and split in 2023 into 52,000km for government and 48,000km for private companies, with Sh940.6m paid to the power utility by June 2025. The same account puts broadband subscriptions at 52.85 million by March 2026 against 22.08 million in June 2020, fixed internet at 2.66 million, 4G population coverage at 73.4% and 5G at 3.04%. The 37,000km is the minister's own figure and no route or county breakdown stands behind it.

On the delivery side of the same programme, coordination was stepped up rather than the schedule revised: two principal secretaries began co-chairing a standing review of the implementing agencies on 4 September, the coordination framed against a target of taking the technology industry from US$7bn to US$100bn. No revised delivery date came with it, and 63,000km of the 100,000km fibre target remains outstanding before the 2027 deadline.

One wholesale fibre entrant is leaving. Airtel is winding up its Kenyan fibre subsidiary after two years, having returned its facilities licence.

The backbone went back to tender. The ICT Authority issued framework agreements for national backbone links and cross-border and metro links under the World Bank-financed digital economy project, each for three years extendable by two, with Treasury putting public-sector fibre at 30,454km in 2026 against 22,486km in 2022. No award is held.

The Communications Authority called stakeholders to an online validation forum on 30 September to finalise its draft guidelines for commercial internet telephony services, having published the consultation responses and its position on each. The draft text is not held.

Lesotho

Vodacom Lesotho launched a fully managed enterprise satellite service built on Starlink in Maseru, reported 9 October 2026, offered as primary connectivity, as backup and combined with terrestrial links.

Libya

The telecommunications authority held a first workshop with the ITU and the national crisis management centre to review the national emergency telecommunications plan, reported on 28 September; the plan was conceived after communications with Derna failed during Storm Daniel in 2023. Negotiations between a satellite internet operator and the regulator, open since 2024, have reached no agreement. One operator's published tariff card runs from 0.5 LYD for 50MB over one day to 80 LYD for 80GB over thirty days. A state holding-company subsidiary reviewed its project for 7,000 telecommunications towers at its general assembly; no count of towers built, cost or completion date is published.

Madagascar

The satellite route to isolated areas moved from announcement to hardware: the digital ministry received 300 satellite kits with free internet service under a partnership with the operator, after free connectivity at the main public universities. No site list is published.

Malawi

An independent tower company said it had built 233 sites in 2026, 40% of them in remote rural areas, with 55 more due by early October, 28 of them rural, at a meeting where the regulator urged lower-cost infrastructure for underserved communities. The figures are the company's own.

The regulator said it is investigating complaints of rapid data-bundle depletion on both mobile networks, assessing their charging and billing systems, usage records and the accuracy of deductions, reported on 30 September. It gave no completion date. The communications regulator's director general put the deadline of its data-depletion investigation at mid-November, with controlled tests of whether data deducted matches data used. The regional programme's half-year report records assessments for the 100 universal service fund towers complete and the request for bids under the lender's review, with six of 25 priority e-services onboarded, and puts the acceleration project's financing at US$150m with a second tranche of US$80m expected in July 2028.

Mali

The Senegalese and Malian state fibre operators inaugurated the interconnection of their national backbones at the Kidira-Diboli border crossing.

Mauritania

A satellite broadband operator lists Mauritania among sixteen African markets it aims to launch in during 2026, after about two years seeking a licence; the authorities' conditions concern security guarantees and control over data, and an application with a local partner is pending.

The regulator published on 7 October 2026 its re-inspection of mobile service quality, run from 13 February to 22 March after the operators' deadline to comply had expired, finding persistent breaches of licence obligations by all three operators in voice and mobile data. No sanction is recorded.

Mauritius

The regulator opened a call for applications for a mobile number portability licence; no launch date is given.

Mozambique

The regulator answered complaints about data bundles. It said it is building a tariff management system, due to operate in November 2026, to compare operators' packages, identify the effective price including validity, and stop data running out before a bundle's stated expiry, and that it is restructuring packages in parallel. No rule or sanction has been published yet.

The finance and communications ministries invited expressions of interest within 15 days from strategic partners for the state operator, including a possible partial sale of the state's shares. The operator's documentation for bidders counts 1.79 million active mobile customers at the end of 2025, up 62.1 per cent on the year, and fixed lines down 20 per cent to 15,537. The regulator put a proposed national Internet para Todos strategy to validation, with 2030 targets for internet use, digital skills and public access points. The regulator validated the national Internet para Todos strategy, which targets 95% broadband coverage and at least 60% of schools connected by 2030.

Namibia

The regulator's April-June bulletin records active mobile subscriber modules up 2 per cent to about 2.79 million, mobile broadband up 2 per cent and fixed broadband up 1 per cent, with about N$243m invested in networks. Modules count connections, not people.

On 28 September the largest mobile operator confirmed 5G in five more towns, Grootfontein, Mariental, Okahandja, Otjiwarongo and Tsumeb, and began building 19 sites across nine regions in a second phase. A second licensed operator launched the low earth orbit constellation's service countrywide, with residential and commercial packages.

Niger

Retail pricing moved without the tariff moving. An operator announced a night bundle of 3.5GB for 500 FCFA usable between 23:00 and 06:00, about 143 FCFA a gigabyte and the second promotional cut in nine months. The last measured basket the repository holds is from 2023. The Nigerien and Algerian ministers launched operation of the fibre link between In Guezzam and Arlit-Agadez; Algeria's account gives a starting capacity of 100 Gbps.

Nigeria

Lagos put a figure on its own build. The state says it has laid about 3,000km of a planned 6,000km unified fibre network between 2019 and 2025 and plans to secure 200-400MW of state-procured electricity, alongside a claim of more than US$80bn in commitments to technology development. Both figures are the state's own, given at a trade exhibition, with no route, cost or independent verification published.

Operators are two-thirds of the way to their site commitments: the regulator's board recorded 8,526 of 12,179 committed coverage and capacity sites deployed, up from about 5,000 at its previous meeting, and blamed fibre cuts for a sharp rise in June disruptions.

The tower programme set a first milestone and the satellite programme a first contract. The ministry said at least 200 towers will be live by December, and Thales Alenia Space signed to build NigComSat-2A. A second virtual network operator began commercial service.

Rural connectivity was folded into the electrification programme. A rural infrastructure company secured a World Bank-backed results-based facility to deploy 2G, 4G, broadband and community Wi-Fi in 500 unserved and underserved communities under the US$750m DARES programme with the Rural Electrification Agency. The account rests on documents seen by one newspaper and gives no facility amount or signing date.

A rural network operator announced a pilot of licensed satellite backhaul at one rural site with its partner Infratel, buying the service through third-party resellers; no start date or result is published.

An operator executive said at the regulator's investment forum on 29 September that more than 13 states had removed right-of-way fees or cut them to the federal benchmark of N145 per metre, adding that separate state road-reinstatement charges offset the saving.

Rwanda

The 2,000-kilometre Goma-to-Mombasa terrestrial route through Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi was announced live and carrying traffic on 9 September, with access to subsea capacity at Mombasa.

Sao Tome and Principe

An independent index put a number on how fragile the connection is. The Internet Society scores the country's internet resilience at 33 out of 100, below the Middle Africa average of 38 and the Africa average of 44, across infrastructure, market readiness, performance and security. It is the first such score the repository holds for the country.

Senegal

The exchange point at Dakar is the month's measurable position: it carries 260 Gbps of member port capacity across six member networks, all six having joined within the preceding twelve months and none having left. The figures are registry self-declarations rather than measured traffic. The older association-run exchange is constituted with its registered office at the telecommunications ministry and names no members, traffic or operating site. The Senegalese and Malian state fibre operators inaugurated the interconnection of their national backbones at the Kidira-Diboli border crossing.

Sierra Leone

The contract to network government offices was challenged. On 21 September the Independent Procurement Review Panel opened an investigation into a bidder's complaint over the Digital Transformation Project's contract to supply and install wide and local area networks across ministries, departments and agencies, and said it would publish the outcome. No award, supplier or contract value is on record. The procurement review panel dismissed a bidder's complaint over the government network contract and directed the ministry to open financial proposals and proceed to award.

Somalia

A business daily reported on 15 September that Berbera is being positioned as an alternative digital gateway for landlocked neighbours, beside Mombasa. Capacity, operators and landing arrangements are not held. A smaller operator's chief executive said voice calls interconnect across six operators while mobile-money wallets remain closed to one another.

South Africa

The competition authority puts wired internet prices up 3.5% and wireless up 4.1% in the first half of 2026, against cumulative headline inflation of 3.8%, compared with rises of 18.6% and 6.4% against inflation of 36% in the six years to July 2026. It is the first period in which a service the authority treats as essential has risen faster than inflation.

The state-affiliated wholesaler, whose network runs to about 180,000km with just under R3bn of capital expenditure a year, completed a third fibre route between Cape Town and Pretoria, via Springbok and Mahikeng, after the double cable break of 2025. No capacity figure has been published for the new route.

A British-funded community network programme launched in August plans R7m for 25 local community network operators in KwaZulu-Natal to deploy 250 public Wi-Fi hotspots, connect 150 public facilities and reach 1,500 homes. It uses the shared open-access model planned for the national wireless network before that network was put on hold.

On 30 September the Competition Commission recommended that the Tribunal approve MTN's acquisition of the tower company IHS, on conditions: non-discriminatory access to the towers for every operator with no preference for MTN SA, fair lease renewals, protection of customers' information, an operationally independent tower business,

and protection of jobs and historically disadvantaged ownership. The Tribunal has not ruled. The minister's reply to Parliament records a R567m write-off of digital-migration inventory in 2025/26; no analogue switch-off date is set. An operator announced more than R500m of network investment in the Western Cape this financial year, naming townships. A costed national roadmap did reach the public: a development bank and planning commission study puts universal household broadband at R108-142bn in 2025 real terms, on a 0.76 square-kilometre hexagonal-grid mapping exercise. A costing, not an appropriation. That company turned a group net profit of R47.3 million against a R1.63 billion loss a year earlier, and the state signal distributor cut its net loss to R60 million from R246 million. The satellite operator said it has applied for licences to bring a direct-to-device service to South Africa with mobile operators, probably from around 2028. The regulator's chairperson said the authority has developed a draft satellite licensing framework.

The Auditor-General's briefing on the 2025/26 audits was reported as finding 2,076 of about 7,800 sites on the state IT agency's network running below 10Mbps and 294 government facilities still on copper. One of the appellants against the Cape Town data-centre approval wrote that the appeal went before the city's Planning Appeals Advisory Panel on 12 October, after which the mayor has 90 days to decide.

South Sudan

The Kenya-facing fibre route moved from plans to procurement. Under the World Bank regional digital project, the ministry invited international bids on 10 September for fibre deployment on Route A-B, from Juba to Nadapal, about 397 km, with bids closing on 26 October 2026.

Sudan

The national operators of Djibouti, Ethiopia and Sudan presented the Horizon Fiber corridor to carriers and equipment vendors at a pre-commercialisation meeting in Addis Ababa on 7 September 2026, ahead of deployment.

Tanzania

The month's other route is a border crossing that has not begun. The foreign minister said the two countries would fast-track a national fibre-optic cable from Kigoma to Kalemie in the Democratic Republic of Congo through Lake Tanganyika, alongside a standard gauge railway link through Burundi and a joint economic commission. No route survey, cost, financing, landing point or delivery date is published.

The regulator scored quality for the quarter to June 2026: the state operator highest at 98.1%, ahead of the largest operator at 97.7% and the third at 97.1% — the state operator leading on quality while holding a small share of the market. The measurement's components and the underlying market shares are not stated. The state operator agreed with the Burundian backbone operator to raise cross-border capacity from 4Gbps to 10Gbps, reported 9 September.

The service providers' association upgraded the Dar es Salaam exchange's core switching to 100G on 23 September; the exchange connects 66 networks and averaged about 205 Gbps in late September against about 110 Gbps a year earlier, on its own statistics. The regulator's director general put available international capacity at 17,690 Gbps, of which 2,731 Gbps, or 15.4%, was in use in June 2026.

The same presentation put smartphone penetration at 44.74% in June 2026, against the regulator's 42.5% for March; no user count accompanies it.

Togo

The regulator's first national monitoring campaign of 2026, across 86 locations from 13 July to 21 August, found neither mobile operator meeting its quality standards, at 75.15 and 54.07 per cent overall compliance, with quality lower outside Greater Lome. A civic-space monitor's country page records no internet shutdown.

Tunisia

On 29 September the incumbent's chief executive put its national fibre network at more than 70,000 km, the operator's own figure with no route inventory behind it.

Uganda

A second international route is being procured under a presidential directive rather than by tender. The state transmission company cancelled open bidding for a commercialisation partner for its fibre network and moved to prepare a proposal for a single named company for the Uganda-Tanzania connection, the parliamentary committee on state enterprises asking why firms that had expressed interest were dropped. A State House letter of 27 August 2025 had told the ICT and energy ministers that a Tanzanian route could be cheaper than the existing route through Kenya, which the President described as full of commercial players looking for profit. No contract, value, timetable or committee finding is held, and the cost comparison is an assertion.

The second operator followed with a service rather than a partnership: it launched Starlink satellite-to-mobile SMS and light data for compatible smartphones on 24 September, free for 30 days and then through its data bundles, with no coverage or subscriber figure.

The President directed cancellation of the agreement to revive the state telecoms operator, the investor having failed to inject an initial US$25m while seeking control of the national backbone; a Cabinet paper on a state-funded revival is to follow.

Zambia

A second account of the same period puts internet subscriptions at 14.7m in 2025 against 10.4m in 2021, and mobile population coverage at 95% over 2022 to 2025. The coverage figure is government-reported and does not reconcile with the ministry's own separate claim for the same period — a reminder that every coverage number here comes from the same source as the target it is measured against.

A mobile operator is acquiring about 1,300 km of fibre from a related company in the same group for K324.9 million, independently valued and classed as a small related-party transaction (21 September). It moves existing fibre between two companies of one group; it adds no route.

Zimbabwe

The largest operator will shut down its 3G network by the end of December 2027, its chief executive said in an account of 10 September, retiring 3G before 2G because 2G remains widely used in rural areas.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-12**
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/infra-connect/infra-connect-monthly-2026-10-12.pdf
FEEDBACK	info@data-landscapers.io
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0